

Since we're all Google addicts here, let's get a closer insight into its search engine and how it works. Firstly, Google uses an algorithm called PageRank, which does what it's supposed to do—rank some pages over others, which appear earlier in the search results. (Technically, it's not just the original PageRank algorithm now, but we'll just say "PageRank" for simplicity's sake.)

PageRank analyses links available for the search engine and assigns a numerical weighting to each element of a hyperlinked set of documents, such as the World Wide Web, with the purpose of "measuring" its relative importance within the set. PageRank was developed at Stanford University by Larry Page (hence the name *PageRank*) and Sergey Brin as part of a research project about a new kind of search engine.

Search engine optimisers widely agree that the things that influence a page's rankings include:

- Keywords in the Title tag.
- Keywords in links pointing to the page.
- Keywords appearing in visible text.
- Link popularity (PageRank for Google) of the page.

"Black hat" SEO are methods to try to improve rankings that are disapproved of by the search engines and/or involve decep-



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